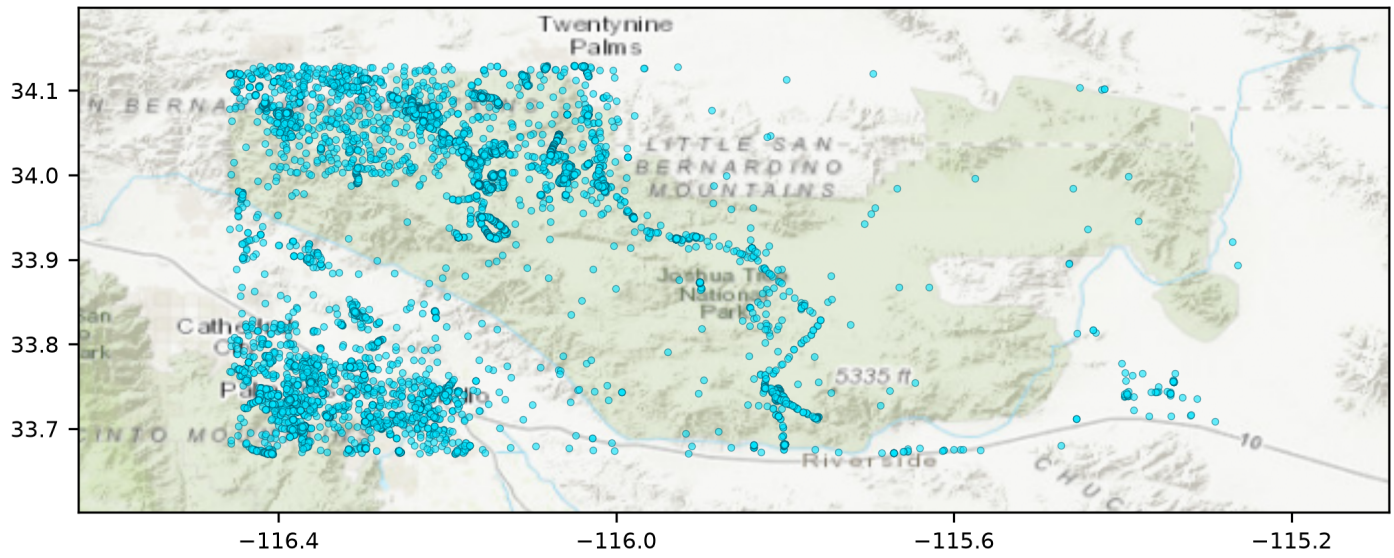
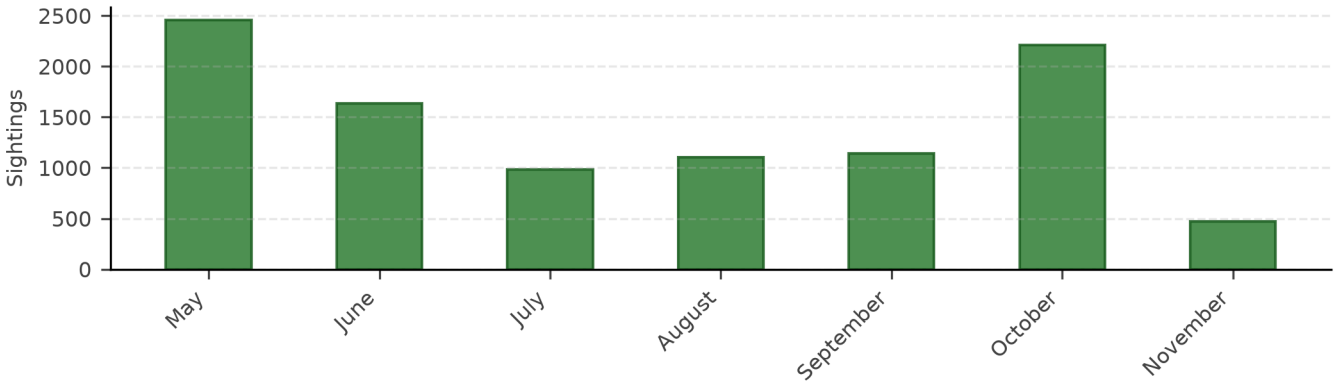
Biodiversity Field Guide: Joshua Tree National Park

Data Gathered via iNaturalist (Most recent 10,000 observations)

Wildlife Sighting Distribution



Monthly Observation Counts



Most Observed Species (Top 35)

Rank	Species (Common Name / Scientific Name)	Sightings	% of Observations
1	Western Joshua Tree (Yucca brevifolia)	290	2.9%
2	Desert Spiny Lizard (Sceloporus magister)	187	1.87%
3	Common Side-blotched Lizard (Uta stansburiana)	172	1.72%
4	Silver Cholla (Cylindropuntia echinocarpa)	164	1.64%
5	Branched Pencil Cholla (Cylindropuntia ramosissima)	156	1.56%
6	Western Whiptail (Aspidoscelis tigris)	141	1.41%
7	Mojave Yucca (Yucca schidigera)	130	1.3%
8	Common Raven (Corvus corax)	129	1.29%
9	Creosote Bush (Larrea tridentata)	126	1.26%
10	Catclaw Acacia (Senegalia greggii)	122	1.22%
11	Common Chuckwalla (Sauromalus ater)	118	1.18%
12	California Buckwheat (Eriogonum fasciculatum)	108	1.08%
13	California juniper (Juniperus californica)	94	0.94%
14	Greater Roadrunner (Geococcyx californianus)	92	0.92%
15	Muller's oak (Quercus cornelius-mulleri)	90	0.9%
16	California Barrel Cactus (Ferocactus cylindraceus)	90	0.9%
17	Paperbag Bush (Scutellaria mexicana)	88	0.88%
18	Southwestern Speckled Rattlesnake (Crotalus pyrrhus)	87	0.87%
19	Zebra-tailed Lizard (Callisaurus draconoides)	85	0.85%
20	Costa's Hummingbird (Calypte costae)	85	0.85%
21	Black-throated Sparrow (Amphispiza bilineata)	84	0.84%
22	Long-nosed Leopard Lizard (Gambelia wislizenii)	80	0.8%
23	Gambel's Quail (Callipepla gambelii)	80	0.8%
24	Beavertail Pricklypear (Opuntia basilaris)	77	0.77%
25	Desert Trumpet (Eriogonum inflatum)	74	0.74%
26	Desert Iguana (Dipsosaurus dorsalis)	74	0.74%
27	Teddybear Cholla (Cylindropuntia bigelovii)	73	0.73%
28	Desert Cottontail (Sylvilagus audubonii)	71	0.71%
29	Long-tailed Brush Lizard (Urosaurus graciosus)	68	0.68%
30	Queen (Danaus gilippus)	67	0.67%
31	Wedgeleaf Goldenbush (Ericameria cuneata)	66	0.66%
32	White-tailed Antelope Squirrel (Ammospermophilus leucurus)	64	0.64%
33	Mediterranean House Gecko (Hemidactylus turcicus)	64	0.64%
34	Coyote (Canis latrans)	63	0.63%
35	Mallard (Anas platyrhynchos)	63	0.63%

Top 20 Dominant Regional Flora (Plants)

#1 Western Joshua Tree
Yucca brevifolia
Sightings: **290**
Peak: **October** (67 obs)

#2 Silver Cholla
Cylindropuntia echinocarpa
Sightings: **164**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#3 Branched Pencil Cholla
Cylindropuntia ramosissima
Sightings: **156**
Peak: **May** (44 obs)

#4 Mojave Yucca
Yucca schidigera
Sightings: **130**
Peak: **May** (35 obs)

#5 Creosote Bush
Larrea tridentata
Sightings: **126**
Peak: **October** (30 obs)

#6 Catclaw Acacia
Senegalia greggii
Sightings: **122**
Peak: **May** (42 obs)

#7 California Buckwheat
Eriogonum fasciculatum
Sightings: **108**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)

#8 California juniper
Juniperus californica
Sightings: **94**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)

#9 Muller's oak
Quercus cornelius-mulleri
Sightings: **90**
Peak: **October** (28 obs)

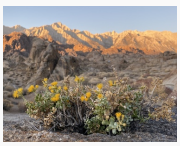
#10 California Barrel Cactus
Ferocactus cylindraceus
Sightings: **90**
Peak: **October** (31 obs)

#11 Paperbag Bush
Scutellaria mexicana
Sightings: **88**
Peak: **May** (67 obs)

#12 Beavertail Pricklypear
Opuntia basilaris
Sightings: **77**
Peak: **May** (38 obs)

#13 Desert Trumpet
Eriogonum inflatum
Sightings: **74**
Peak: **May** (29 obs)

#14 Teddybear Cholla
Cylindropuntia bigelovii
Sightings: **73**
Peak: **October** (17 obs)



#15 Wedgeleaf Goldenbush
Ericameria cuneata
Sightings: **66**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#16 jojoba
Simmondsia chinensis
Sightings: **62**
Peak: **October** (21 obs)

#17 Chia
Salvia columbariae
Sightings: **62**
Peak: **May** (34 obs)

#18 Mesquite Mistletoe
Phoradendron californicum
Sightings: **60**
Peak: **May** (31 obs)

#19 apricot globemallow
Sphaeralcea ambigua
Sightings: **58**
Peak: **May** (35 obs)

#20 ocotillo
Fouquieria splendens
Sightings: **52**
Peak: **October** (22 obs)

Top 20 Dominant Regional Fauna (Animals)

#1 Desert Spiny Lizard
Sceloporus magister
Sightings: **187**
Peak: **June** (51 obs)

#2 Common Side-blotched Lizard
Uta stansburiana
Sightings: **172**
Peak: **October** (43 obs)

#3 Western Whiptail
Aspidoscelis tigris
Sightings: **141**
Peak: **May** (41 obs)

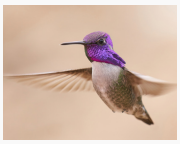
#4 Common Raven
Corvus corax
Sightings: **129**
Peak: **June** (35 obs)

#5 Common Chuckwalla
Sauromalus ater
Sightings: **118**
Peak: **May** (62 obs)

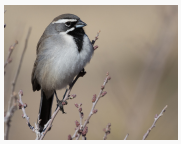
#6 Greater Roadrunner
Geococcyx californianus
Sightings: **92**
Peak: **June** (23 obs)

#7 Southwestern Speckled Rattlesnake
Crotalus pyrrhus
Sightings: **87**
Peak: **June** (35 obs)

#8 Zebra-tailed Lizard
Callisaurus draconoides
Sightings: **85**
Peak: **May** (32 obs)



#9 Costa's Hummingbird
Calypte costae
Sightings: **85**
Peak: **October** (26 obs)



#10 Black-throated Sparrow
Amphispiza bilineata
Sightings: **84**
Peak: **May** (25 obs)

#11 Long-nosed Leopard Lizard
Gambelia wislizenii
Sightings: **80**
Peak: **May** (61 obs)

#12 Gambel's Quail
Callipepla gambelii
Sightings: **80**
Peak: **August** (22 obs)

#13 Desert Iguana
Dipsosaurus dorsalis
Sightings: **74**
Peak: **May** (34 obs)

#14 Desert Cottontail
Sylvilagus audubonii
Sightings: **71**
Peak: **June** (20 obs)

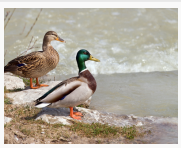
#15 Long-tailed Brush Lizard
Urosaurus graciosus
Sightings: **68**
Peak: **August** (38 obs)

#16 Queen
Danaus gilippus
Sightings: **67**
Peak: **October** (18 obs)

#17 White-tailed Antelope Squirrel
Ammospermophilus leucurus
Sightings: **64**
Peak: **September** (14 obs)

#18 Mediterranean House Gecko
Hemidactylus turcicus
Sightings: **64**
Peak: **August** (24 obs)

#19 Coyote
Canis latrans
Sightings: **63**
Peak: **October** (15 obs)



#20 Mallard
Anas platyrhynchos
Sightings: **63**
Peak: **October** (32 obs)